

RUMMY

Rummy (also called Basic Rummy or Standard Rummy) is the foundational draw-and-discard game from which Gin Rummy, Canasta, and many other games descend. Unlike Gin Rummy, melds are placed face-up on the table during play and opponents may extend them.

PLAYERS AND CARDS

2–6 players. Standard 52-card deck. Aces may be high or low (agree before play). Face cards = 10 points; numbered cards = face value.

THE DEAL

PLAYERS	CARDS DEALT
2	10 each
3–4	7 each
5–6	6 each

Remaining cards form the **stock** face-down. Top card is turned up to start the **discard pile**.

MELDS

A **meld** is either:

- ♦ **Set (Group):** 3 or 4 cards of the same rank (e.g., three 7s)
- ♦ **Run (Sequence):** 3 or more consecutive cards of the same suit (e.g., 4♥–5♥–6♥)

THE TURN

On each turn a player must:

- 1 **Draw** — take the top card of the stock OR the top card of the discard pile
- 2 **Meld (optional)** — lay one or more melds face-up on the table
- 3 **Lay off (optional)** — add cards to any existing meld on the table (your own or opponents')
- 4 **Discard** — place one card face-up on the discard pile (may be omitted if going out with no remaining cards)

GOING OUT

A player goes out by melding or laying off all cards in their hand, ending their turn with an empty hand.

GOING RUMMY

If a player goes out in a single turn without having previously melded or laid off anything during the game, they “go Rummy.” All opponents score **double** penalty points for their unmelded cards.

SCORING

When a player goes out, all other players count the **face value of unmelded cards** in their hands as penalty points. Scores accumulate across hands. The player who first reaches a target total (e.g., 100 points) loses; the player with the lowest cumulative score wins.